
THE HOME SERVICE BRAND MACHINE

UNIVERSAL PLAYBOOK v2.0 · BRAND SYSTEM · CREATIVE
ENGINEERING · AD SCIENCE · MONEY MODELS · SEO · SCALE LAWS

One operating manual for taking any home-service company — HVAC, plumbing, landscaping, steel buildings, roofing, electrical — from zero to eight figures on the same laws: verifiably real creative, offers engineered on the Value Equation, media bought with discipline, and a money model that compounds.

Built and battle-tested on Glacier Heating & Air (San Antonio). Every rule shipped. Every framework is named. Every number is labeled — ours or industry. Nothing decorative survives in this document.

REFERENCE BUILD: CALLGLACIER.COM · Compiled July 2026 · Internal & Confidential · v2.0 UNIVERSAL

0. Operating Philosophy — Read This or Read Nothing

The machine has four gears, in causal order: OFFER (what you promise) → CREATIVE (how the promise is seen) → MEDIA (how attention is bought) → MONEY MODEL (how a lead becomes compounding revenue). Businesses stall because they polish gear 3 while gear 1 is broken. Diagnose in order. Always.

The diagnostic spine (Hormozi's 6M): when growth stalls, find the ONE constraint — **Metrics** (do you even know your numbers?), **Model** (does the math work at \$1?), **Money** (cash cycle), **Manpower** (who does the work), **Manager** (who runs the who), **Market** (is demand real). One constraint at a time. Fixing non-constraints is procrastination with a to-do list.

THE HONESTY LAW (supersedes everything): nothing ships — ad, post, page, schema, pitch — containing a claim that isn't true and verifiable today. Not because of ethics posters: because the entire competitive moat of this system is being the only verifiably real company in a feed of stock-photo slop. One disprovable number (a fake temperature, an invented review count) poisons every true claim around it. Accuracy IS the brand.

1. The Offer Layer (Hormozi: Grand Slam Offers & the Value Equation)

1.1 The Value Equation — the physics of "yes"

Value = (Dream Outcome × Perceived Likelihood) ÷ (Time Delay × Effort & Sacrifice). Home-service buyers aren't buying the service; they're buying *certainty against a feared outcome* (the surprise invoice, the flooded slab, the collapsed carport, the dead lawn). Engineer all four levers:

Lever	Universal move	Glacier proof
Dream outcome	Name the FEAR, not the service	"Your price in writing, before we start" — kills mystery-invoice fear
Likelihood	Verifiable proof: real job photos, real forecast, license shown	"REAL GLACIER INSTALL" badges; accurate 5-day heat strip
Time delay	Speed language you can keep: "fast callback," "often same-day"	<5-minute callback SOP
Effort	Show the tiny process ON the creative: 3 numbered steps	"Takes about a minute. We call back fast. Price in writing."

1.2 The Grand Slam Offer per vertical (the fear → the promise)

Vertical	#1 buyer fear	Grand Slam attraction offer
HVAC	Mystery invoice / breakdown at peak	Free exact-price estimate, in writing, before a tool comes out — the number doesn't move
Plumbing	Small leak becomes catastrophic bill	Free camera/diagnosis with flat written price by symptom class; "no drip left behind" workmanship promise
Landscaping	Paying monthly for invisible work	Written scope with photo-proof after every visit; first service free if the before/after doesn't show
Steel buildings	Deposit vanishes / spec creep / delays	Fixed engineered quote with drawings before deposit; milestone payments tied to photographed progress

Offer construction rule: the attraction offer must cost you near-zero marginal dollars and remove the #1 fear entirely. That's how value rises without price falling — the whole point of a Grand Slam Offer. Discounting is what companies do when they can't engineer value.

2. The Brand System (Universal Laws, Vertical Skins)

2.1 The invariant frame (works for any company)

THE FRAME LAW: every canvas carries — accent rail across the very top · logo mark + "BRAND NAME · CITY" eyebrow · contact footer (phone with icon + domain pill). Content changes in the middle; the frame never does. Recognition is repetition of an invariant frame across hundreds of assets. One brand = one frame = one glance.

- **One palette** (dark authority base + one cool trust tone + one hot action accent + one neutral). Glacier: navy #002B58 / ice #1573A8 / red #E11F26 / slate. A plumber might run deep blue/aqua/orange; landscaper forest/lime/amber; steel buildings graphite/steel-blue/safety-yellow. Same ROLES, different skins.
- **One typeface family, three weights** (display Black, subhead ExtraBold, body Bold). Montserrat is the house default. A second typeface is a second brand — forbidden.
- **The mark is sacred:** placed from the master file only. Never AI-rendered, never redrawn, never recolored per-asset. Pixel-verified on every render (automated check, §3.4).
- **NAP law:** Name/Address/Phone character-identical across site, GBP, ads, citations, footers. One character of drift costs local rank.
- **Voice:** established (never "new"), short sentences, mechanisms over adjectives, only offers that exist, zero corporate filler. The reader should hear a competent human, not a brochure.

2.2 Composition laws (why our canvases "pop")

1. **One idea per canvas.** One hook, one photo, one CTA. Every extra element is an exit ramp.
2. **Hierarchy by size-contrast:** the hook element (giant numeral, split photo, kneeling tech) is 3–5× body scale. If everything is loud, nothing is.
3. **Measured, never eyeballed:** layouts computed from ink bounding boxes; groups centered as one measured unit; banners flush to footers; no orphan whitespace. Deterministic code renders (Python/Pillow @2x supersample, single downscale) — a human judging alignment means the layout is wrong.
4. **No diagonals on standalone elements** — a tilted strike beside level type always reads broken. Horizontal strikes computed from ink bounds with equal overshoot.
5. **Legibility floor:** headline readable at 350px preview width; gradient scrims (measured alpha ramps, never smears) behind any text over photography; eyebrow ≥ #200-alpha scrim on busy tops.
6. **Real photography carries authority:** golden hour > noon > flash; label real work proudly ("REAL [BRAND] JOB PHOTO"). Authenticity badges are the anti-stock weapon in every home-service feed.

2.3 Web standard (back end to front end)

- Static-exported Next.js (or equivalent): sub-second loads, zero server risk, free hosting tier. Design system tokens = the brand palette; every page from shared components (PageHero, FAQ, CTA band, JsonLd) so the site cannot drift off-brand.
- Page architecture that prints local SEO: Home · Service hub → one page per service · City hub → one page per suburb (tiered) · Money pages (financing, membership/continuity, reviews) · Blog engine with branded real-photo covers that double as og-images.
- Technical floor (non-negotiable): unique titles ≤60ch, unique descriptions, canonicals matched EXACTLY by sitemap URLs (trailing-slash discipline — redirects between sitemap and canonical tax every crawl), single H1, breadcrumb + business + service + FAQ + article schema, business schema anchored by @id and referenced (never duplicated inline), all schema images on own domain, NO aggregate ratings until verifiable.

3. Creative Engineering SOP (the render factory)

3.1 The doctrine

REAL PHOTOS ONLY in performance creative. No AI imagery, no generative fill, no stock, no smears/overlays. AI visualization is permitted solely for labeled mockups that never masquerade as real. When a real photo must be edited (a phone number on a wrap), apply the **minimal-edit doctrine**: preserve every original element, replace only unavoidable pixels, inherit measured perspective/lighting/grain — re-authored blocks always read fake.

3.2 The Four-Render Rule

Every ad ships as four hand-composed files — never platform-auto-cropped: ① 4:5 master (2160×2700) ② 1:1 (2160×2160) ③ 9:16 (2160×3840; critical content inside story safe zones ~y270–1560 @1x; quiet brand zone under the footer) ④ 1.91:1 (2400×1256; recomposed two-column). Plus a JPG (q92) twin of each for upload limits. Auto-crop guillotines layouts; it is banned.

3.3 Photo pipeline (the only allowed processing)

Catalog every job photo (grade A/B/C, group by job, tag best-use). Enhancement = measured color science only: LAB levels stretch (p0.5–p99.6), CLAHE blended ~28%, half-strength gray-world white balance, saturation ×1.06, gentle unsharp; EDSR ×2 super-resolution for small sources. Nothing added or removed from any scene.

Funnel congruence law: the equipment in ad photos must match the funnel's questions (an AC form gets AC imagery — a pump photo pulls plumbing intent into an AC form and burns completion rate).

3.4 QA gates (automated + human, every render)

1. Mark-pixel check: scan eyebrow band for the mark's accent pixels; below threshold = blocked.
2. Ink-band geometry: verify content density in every expected zone (headline/checks/banner/footer).
3. Human pass at phone size: crops, digits, spelling, clipped text.
4. Claims audit vs. the Honesty Law.

4. Ad Science — Why Creative Wins or Dies

4.1 The governing equation

$CPL = CPM \div (CTR \times CVR \times 1000)$. Creative attacks CTR. Offer + form attack CVR. Engagement quality attacks CPM (platforms bill less for creative people don't scroll past). Every optimization is one of these three attacks; anything else is theater.

4.2 The hook taxonomy (one per ad, never blended)

Hook	Psychology	Universal template	Glacier proof
MOMENT/urgency	External deadline viewer already believes	Weather strip, season countdown, permit deadline	97° forecast ad w/ real 5-day climb
TRUST/stranger-fear	Who enters my home/property?	Process-on-canvas; vetted-crew proof	"Your price in writing, before we start"
MONEY/smart-math	Loss aversion, pride in good decisions	Before/after split + cost-of-inaction line	Old-vs-new: "the electric bill collects its pension"
PROOF/anti-generic	Contrast vs stock-photo feed	"Straight off a crew phone" authenticity	"No staging. No stock photos. Just Tuesday."
CHARACTER/memory	Distinctive assets compound recall	Mascot as recurring cast member	The yeti

4.3 The attention layer (MrBeast physics, translated)

- **First frame = whole promise.** WHO + WHAT + WHY-CARE must land in <1 second, pre-reading. If the hook needs the caption, the hook failed.
- **Promise → payoff integrity:** the click must land exactly where the ad pointed (the form asks what the ad said it would ask). Congruence is conversion's version of retention.
- **Remove exit ramps:** each confusing element is where attention leaves.
- **Improve the NEXT one:** versioned creative, kept fresh — the library compounds like a channel's back catalog.

4.4 The autopsy list (why ads die)

1. Stock creative (category recognition, zero trust)
2. No offer (nothing to act on today)
3. Adjective claims without proof ("excellence at every step")
4. Component mismatch (headline sells X, image shows Y)
5. Funnel incongruence (click intent ≠ form questions)
6. One disprovable fact (poisons all true ones)
7. Fatigue past frequency ~2.5–3 with sagging CTR
8. Founder panic-edits mid-learning (each resets the algorithm's education)

5. Copy System

5.1 Primary text architecture (3–5 options per ad, always)

Hook line that stands alone above the fold → mechanism/agitation in 2–3 short air-separated paragraphs → offer restated as the reader's self-interest → stacked contact block (phone / domain). One long, one medium, one short — the platform matches length to reader. Headlines ≤ ~40 characters, restating MECHANISM not slogan; descriptions close the loop and compress risk-reversal ("say no anytime").

5.2 Universal line formulas (with the Glacier originals)

FEAR-KILLER:	"Your price in writing, before a single tool comes out — and it doesn't move."
ANTI-SLEAZE:	"No upsell games. No mystery invoices. Just [outcome]."
MOMENT:	"Tired [systems/pipes/roofs] pick weeks like this to quit."
HUMAN-TRUST:	"You're not hiring a logo. You're hiring whoever kneels next to your [system]."
SMART-MATH:	"Every month it limps along, the [utility bill] collects its pension."
AUTHENTICITY:	"No staging. No stock photos. Just Tuesday."
RISK-REVERSAL:	"If the number doesn't work for you, you say no, and we part friends."
IDENTITY:	"Built for [regional hardship], run on [regional virtue]."

5.3 Sales scripts (NEPQ posture: calm, curious, permission-based)

B2B cold (selling leads/services to owners): name the cold call → permission for 30 seconds → "not sure we can even help you" disarm → the leak question ("...how many of those actually call you?") → one claim ("one install pays for it") → 15-minute look with the confidence exit ("if yours wins, I'll tell you to keep it") → two-option close. **Consumer callback (60s):** name → mirror their stated problem → ONE grading question → two-option close on the visit → restate the written-price promise. Every published line is a promise the phone must keep.

6. Media Buying SOP (Meta-first, platform-agnostic laws)

Layer	Law
Structure	ONE broad ad set per market (residents, 28+, minimal interests; the creatives ARE the targeting) · 3–5 hook-distinct ads inside · CBO. Naming: MKT Objective Funnel / MKT - Concept - Angle .
Forms	Higher-intent + OTP verification + grading questions. NEVER volume forms — they optimize the dashboard and destroy the product (\$7).
Platform "help"	All AI creative enhancements OFF (re-enable silently on duplicate — recheck every time). Opportunity scores, blue Apply buttons, dialog recommendations: categorically ignored. "Duplicate original setup," always.
Learning	72-hour no-touch law after any change. Judge nothing on day 1–2. First ~10 conversions are the algorithm's tuition.
Kill/Feed	Kill: $\geq \$90$ spent + 0 leads + CTR $< 0.7\%$. Feed winner +20% per 72h. Never judge long-cycle (replacement/build) ads on week-1 CPL.
Freshness	New creative every 2–3 weeks; moment ads (weather/season) re-cut weekly so they're never wrong.
Benchmarks	CTR: fail $< 0.7\%$ / operator 1–1.5% / elite 2%+. CPM local service: \$15–25 operator, \$10–18 elite. Form completion: 15–25% operator, 30%+ elite. CPL (verified higher-intent): \$40–70 operator, \$20–40 elite, teens only in demand spikes. Speed-to-lead: <5 minutes, every lead — the single highest-ROI behavior in the entire document (contact odds collapse ~21× between minute 5 and 30).
Scaling	+20% steps, never doublings; expect CPL to rise with budget (auction depth). Cheap and big don't coexist.

7. Money Models (Hormozi stages, home-service edition)

7.1 The ladder

1. **Attraction offer** — the Grand Slam fear-killer (\$1.2), near-zero marginal cost.
2. **Core offer** — repair → replacement / fix → remodel / mow → landscape-design upgrade paths, sold on honest math (e.g., the $\frac{1}{3}$ rule: repair $> \frac{1}{3}$ of replacement on an old unit → replace).
3. **Continuity** — membership club (tune-ups, priority, discounts): recurring cash + owned audience + review engine. Every vertical has one (HVAC club, plumbing protection plan, lawn care subscription, building maintenance contract).
4. **Downstream monetization** — the lead book itself: exclusive, verified, graded leads wholesaled to capacity partners. Moat = speed + verification + exclusivity.

7.2 Lead economics (the resale discipline)

Grade	Signals (form-derived)	Price (HVAC ref.)
A	Owns + dead/urgent + old system (replacement-probable)	\$85–100
B	Owns + urgent + repair-shaped	\$55–65
C	Owns + soft urgency	\$35–45
D	Planner	hold/batch
F	Renter/unqualified	\$0 — never invoiced (protects the book's trust)

THE SPREAD DOCTRINE: CPL is vanity; **spread = sale price – cost per SOLD lead** is the business. Junk \$15 leads sell for \$20 with refund wars (negative spread). Verified \$45–55 leads selling exclusive at \$55–100 compound. Anchor-defense line for buyers staring at their service-call fee: *"Angi sells that same homeowner to you AND three competitors for \$60 each. I'm giving you the only copy."* Buyer's real math: \$350–600 avg repair ticket, ~1-in-3 lead → revenue, replacement conversions \$3–5k gross — expected profit per exclusive lead \$150–300+.

8. Lead Gen Beyond Paid (Hormozi's Core Four, operationalized)

The Core Four channels — **warm outreach, cold outreach, content, paid ads** — all run off this system's assets:

- **Content (organic):** the 80/20 page — 80% value (tips franchise, real-job stories, education), 20% brand moments, 0% raw ads. The page is the proof file ad-clickers audit before calling. Tips franchise: branded eyebrow, unnumbered, weekly, fact-verified.
- **Paid:** \$6.
- **Cold outreach:** the B2B script (\$5.3) selling the lead book / partnerships.
- **Warm/referral:** continuity members + review engine; every completed job triggers a review ask within 24h (recency compounds map-pack rank).

8.1 SEO machine (the free-lead flywheel)

- **Technical floor** (\$2.3) — done once, defended forever.
- **Content flywheel:** articles targeting buying-intent queries ("[symptom] [city]", "[service] cost [city] [year]", seasonal checklists) with Article+FAQ schema, branded real-photo covers as og-images, internal links into service/city pages. Cadence law: 2–3/month forever > 12 in January. Search Console Performance (impressions at position >10) dictates next topics — the engine literally tells you what it wants to rank you for.
- **Off-site ladder:** ① NAP citations (GBP, Bing import-from-GBP, Apple Business Connect, Yelp, BBB, Nextdoor) ② manufacturer/association links (dealer locators = the strongest single link in any equipment

trade; chamber; trade association) ③ earned local (seasonal sponsorships; weather/seasonal PR pitches with your education content).

- **Timeline truth:** new domains sandbox for months. 1–2: impressions. 3–6: long-tail wins. 6–12: head terms — if links/reviews/content stacked. Map pack moves faster than organic and IS the "near me" money. Paid buys revenue now; SEO buys margin later. "Page one in 30 days" sellers are selling scams or penalties.

9. The Scale Laws (\$0 → 8 figures, constraint by constraint)

Stage	Revenue	The constraint (6M)	The move
0. Proof	\$0–10k/mo	METRICS + MODEL	One market, one funnel, one offer. Prove: CPL, contact rate, close rate, ticket, spread. Founder answers every lead in <5 min. (Glacier: here — machine live, first paid lead landed, unit math visible.)
1. Repeatability	\$10–50k/mo	MONEY	Winner creative fed; continuity launched (cash smoothing); buyer book at standing orders; review engine on.
2. Capacity	\$50–150k/mo	MANPOWER	Hire against the phone first (speed-to-lead is the first thing founders drop). Playbook = training doc; QA gates keep creative standard hire-proof.
3. Management	\$150–400k/mo	MANAGER	Weekly councils run without the founder; dashboards from \$6 benchmarks; creative factory produces on cadence not inspiration.
4. Multiplication	\$400k+/mo	MARKET	Clone the machine: new metro (same vertical) or new vertical (same metro) — swap the skin tables (§1.2, §2.1), keep every law. The document you are reading is the franchise.

The 20-hour rule: if a stage feels stuck and you haven't spent 20 focused hours on its named constraint — you haven't started. Volume of focused work on the right constraint is the strategy. Everything else is a spectator sport.

10. The Weekly Operating System (whole company, one page)

Cadence	Ritual
Every lead	<5-min callback → grade → matrix price → route/sell fresh with timestamp. No answer: instant text + 1h re-call.
Daily (2 min)	Delivery green · leads answered · NOTHING edited.
Tue/Wed	One organic post (tip / job story / education).
Friday (30 min)	Ads council (kill/feed by data) · GSC Performance + Pages · log buyer prices · update the numbers in this document.
Bi-weekly	One new ad into rotation: 4 renders + JPG twins + QA gates. Moment-ads re-cut weekly.
Monthly	2–3 articles w/ branded covers · citation/link push · P&L: spend vs lead revenue vs spread · version this playbook.

11. Reference Build — Asset Inventory (Glacier)

Asset	Path (repo: glacier-site)
Ad masters (4:5)	brand/ad-hook-v1-heat · ad-hook-v2c-exactprice · ad-hook-v3-oldnew · ad-realwork-1080x1350 (.png + .jpg)
Placement trios	brand/placements/glc-{97,exact,oldnew,crew,hidden,van,yeti}-{1x1,9x16,191}
Organic + tips + posts	brand/social/org-01..04 · tip-01..07 · post1..post18-pinned
Photo library	brand/jobs/raw (27) · enhanced/ · INVENTORY.md
Blog + covers	lib/posts.ts · public/blog/cover-*.jpg
Render factory	scratchpad/make_*.py — deterministic, parameterized, QA-gated; re-skin for any vertical by swapping palette, mark, photo library, and copy tables
Docs	brand/LEAD-FUNNEL.md · META-ADS-PLAYBOOK.md · this document (v1 Glacier edition + v2 universal)

12. Open Punch List (reference build)

- Real TACLA license → footer (TX advertising law; placeholder live).
- Facebook page URL → socials config (Instagram done).
- Real review count once GBP accrues → then, and only then, aggregateRating returns to schema.
- Pixel install → retargeting at ~1,000 visitors/30d.

- Crew-at-equipment photos → unlocks the human-trust hook at full power.
- Every new vertical launch: rebuild \$1.2 fear table + \$2.1 skin + photo library BEFORE any ad spends a dollar.

The Home Service Brand Machine v2.0 · July 2026 · Frameworks credited where due (Hormozi: Value Equation, Grand Slam Offers, Core Four, Money Models, 6M; attention physics per MrBeast's published principles). Every operational law herein shipped on the Glacier reference build. Keep it truthful — the machine runs on it.